Co-Planning Log

Interdisciplinary lesson: Dancehall as a Reflection of Caribbean Society

CSEC Music (Music History) and History/Social Studies (Theme 9: Caribbean Society)

1. Overview

Teachers	Ms. Samantha Joseph (Music) and Ms. Marcela Boatswain (History/Social Studies)
School	St. Joseph's Convent, San Fernando
Class	Form 4 (3 students); 70-minute lesson in a double period
Integration model	Interdisciplinary (Drake & Burns, 2004)
Planning window	September 7–18, 2026
Number of planning sessions	3
Songs used	"Bam Bam" (Sister Nancy) and "Under Mi Sleng Teng" (Wayne Smith)
Lesson dates	Planned for Wednesday, September 23, 2026; postponed and delivered on Wednesday, September 30, 2026
Main constraint	One double period in which the Music teacher taught the Form 4 class and the History/Social Studies teacher was free to co-teach

2. Planning sessions

Session 1: Shared concept and structure

Date	Monday, September 7, 2026
Mode and length	In person, about 40 minutes
Present	Ms. Samantha Joseph (Music); Ms. Marcela Boatswain (History/Social Studies)
Discussion	• Compared the CSEC Music Music History objectives with Theme 9 (Caribbean Society) to find where they overlap. • Weighed the three integration approaches and the fixed syllabus targets against a single 70-minute lesson.
Decisions	• Interdisciplinary model chosen over transdisciplinary. • Shared concept: music reflects and shapes the society that produces it. • Shared skills: using evidence to justify claims; linking context to content. • Essential question: How does the sound of Dancehall reflect the society that created it?
Actions (who)	• Ms. Joseph: list the stylistic elements to teach. • Ms. Boatswain: list the Theme 9 ideas to link. • Both: shortlist possible songs.

Session 2: Songs, versions and suitability

Date	Friday, September 11, 2026
Mode and length	In person, about 45 minutes
Present	Ms. Samantha Joseph (Music); Ms. Marcela Boatswain (History/Social Studies)
Discussion	• Chose the songs and the specific versions of each to use in the lesson. • Discussed the lyrics in detail and their suitability for adolescent students in a Roman Catholic school. • Considered how to handle any sensitive content in class discussion.
Decisions	• Songs selected: “Bam Bam” (Sister Nancy) and “Under Mi Sleng Teng” (Wayne Smith). • Versions selected: clean or radio edits, with only short excerpts played in class. • Discussion norms agreed for sensitive lyrics (describe and analyse, do not repeat).
Actions (who)	• Ms. Joseph: preview the chosen clips and prepare the Listening Guide. • Ms. Boatswain: prepare the timeline and event cards.

Session 3: Finalising the lesson and logistics

Date	Friday, September 18, 2026
Mode and length	In person, about 45 minutes
Present	Ms. Samantha Joseph (Music); Ms. Marcela Boatswain (History/Social Studies)
Discussion	• Mapped each objective to a phase of the lesson. • Agreed roles, assessment and resources. • Looked at the timetable: only one double period suited both teachers.
Decisions	• Roles: Ms. Joseph leads the musical lens; Ms. Boatswain leads the historical lens; both co-facilitate the integrated task, discussion and assessment. • Assessment: one dual-discipline rubric and one exit ticket, scored by both teachers. • Lesson date set for Wednesday, September 23, 2026.
Actions (who)	• Both: finalise the Integrated Song Analysis Organizer, rubric and exit ticket. • Both: set up the wall chart and digital board before the lesson.

3. Key decisions

Decision	Reason	Session
Interdisciplinary model	Learning targets were fixed by two syllabi, and one 70-minute lesson cannot sustain student-driven transdisciplinary inquiry.	1
Shared concept and essential question	Keeps both subjects’ standards visible while giving one question to answer.	1
Songs and versions: “Bam Bam” and “Under Mi Sleng Teng”	Clean or radio edits were chosen as suitable for adolescent students in a Roman Catholic school, after detailed discussion of the lyrics.	2
Discussion norms for sensitive content	To keep analysis respectful and focused on evidence.	2
Team teaching with divided leads	Each teacher leads where their subject expertise is strongest; both stay active throughout.	3
Single dual-discipline rubric	One task can be judged against both subjects’ criteria.	3

4. After planning: scheduling and delivery

Event	Date	What happened	Response
First planned lesson day	Wed., Sept. 23, 2026	Ms. Boatswain unexpectedly became ill and could not co-teach.	The lesson was postponed to the following week, because the double period was the only slot when both teachers were available.
Rescheduled lesson	Wed., Sept. 30, 2026	The lesson was delivered as planned.	No changes were needed to the plan, roles or resources.
During the lesson	Wed., Sept. 30, 2026	The historical context took longer than planned because of Ms. Boatswain's enthusiasm for the topic.	Both teachers adjusted the timing of the subsequent sections together, and the lesson was delivered successfully.

5. Roles and responsibilities

Task	Ms. Joseph (Music)	Ms. Boatswain (History)	Both
Syllabus comparison and shared concept			✓
Song and version selection; lyric suitability			✓
Listening Guide and body-percussion activities	✓		
Timeline slides and event cards		✓	
Integrated Song Analysis Organizer			✓
Rubric and exit ticket			✓
Teaching the musical lens	✓		
Teaching the historical lens		✓	
Integrated task, discussion and assessment			✓